

What v1 builds, and why

Written outcome-back: it starts from the one outcome that matters and traces every epic to it. If a feature doesn't serve the bet, it's deferred.

THE OUTCOME EVERYTHING TRACES TO

North Star — cohesive looks saved and shopped. v1 exists to prove that curating cross-brand pieces into cohesive looks makes people shop by aesthetic here rather than stitching it together across ten apps.

The metric that carries it: save-rate on the curated feed measured against a plain, shuffled multi-brand feed. That single comparison is the bet. Supporting it: boards created, outbound clicks per board, and 4-week return among board-creators. Targets are set from the first tests, not asserted here.

OUTCOME → OPPORTUNITIES → EPICS

Working back from the North Star, three opportunities carry the bet. Every epic hangs off one of them.

Opportunity (user need)	Epics that serve it
See a look that's already mine: a cohesive, on-aesthetic feed without the ten-tab hunt	E1 Aesthetic modes & feed · E2 Filtering · E3 Search & discovery · E7 Feed curator
Hold the look together over time: save, organize, and come back to it	E4 Mood boards · E5 Brand shelf · E6 Price drops
Act on it: actually buy, and let us earn	E8 Accounts · E9 Detail & outbound checkout · E10 Catalog ingestion

HOW TO READ THE EPICS

Each feature is tagged **PROTO** (already shown in the visual prototype) or **NEW** (net-new for a real v1). Acceptance criteria are written as pass/fail bars you can check without asking us what we meant.

GOALS & NON-GOALS (V1)

GOALS

- Pick an aesthetic and get a cohesive, on-palette, multi-brand feed.
- Save, organize, and revisit looks; follow brands.
- Watch prices on saved pieces and surface drops.
- Drive qualified outbound clicks to brand partners.

NON-GOALS

- In-app checkout or payments.
- User-to-user social features.
- Fit and size personalization.
- Our own inventory or logistics.

OPPORTUNITY 1 — SEE A LOOK THAT'S ALREADY MINE

E1 • Aesthetic modes & curated feed

The home experience is a chosen look, pulled from many brands.

Feature	Detail	Type
Aesthetic modes	Distinct modes (Soft Romance / "Muse", Quiet Utility / "STACK"), each its own palette, type, and mix.	PROTO
Masonry feed	Two-column feed of product cards: image, brand, title, price.	PROTO
Mode switch	Switching aesthetic re-curates feed, palette, and shelf.	NEW
Cohesion ranking	Feed ordered for palette and category balance, not random.	NEW
ACCEPTANCE BARS Selecting a mode changes wordmark, palette, and product set · feed loads ≥ 12 pieces from ≥ 4 brands · no single brand exceeds ~40% above the fold · scroll stays smooth with lazy-loaded images.		

E2 · Palette & category filtering

Narrow the feed the way people think, by color and type.

Feature	Detail	Type
Palette filter	Color dots filter the feed to a color family; tap again to clear.	PROTO
Category chips	Scrolling chips filter by category.	PROTO
Combined filters	Palette, category, and search apply together, with a live result count and a friendly empty state.	PROTO
ACCEPTANCE BARS Active filter is visually distinct · filters combine (AND) and update the count on every change · empty state appears at zero results and clears when loosened.		

E3 · Search & "more like this" discovery

Feature	Detail	Type
Search	Free-text over brand, title, category.	PROTO
Product detail	Full-screen: hero, brand, title, price, color, description, save.	PROTO
More like this	Grid of pieces sharing palette or category.	PROTO
Semantic search	Understands vibe terms ("cottagecore," "going-out top").	NEW
ACCEPTANCE BARS Search filters live while typing and keeps input focus · detail opens from a card and returns to the same scroll position · "more like this" shows ≥ 3 relevant pieces excluding the current one.		

E4 · Mood boards

Feature	Detail	Type
Save to board	Save any piece; a sheet to pick one or more boards.	PROTO
Create board	Create a new board inline while saving.	PROTO
Boards view	Grid with cover collage and count; open to see pieces.	PROTO
Persistence & sharing	Boards persist to the account; share a board via read-only link.	NEW

ACCEPTANCE BARS Saving updates saved-state and shows a toast · a new board immediately holds its first piece
 · covers reflect real saved pieces · boards survive logout/login unchanged.

E5 · Brand shelf & follow

Feature	Detail	Type
Shelf list	Brands in the current aesthetic with piece and drop counts.	PROTO
Follow / unfollow	Follow to weight a brand into the feed.	PROTO
Follow influences feed	Followed brands appear more; unfollowed less.	NEW

ACCEPTANCE BARS Follow toggles instantly with a toast · state persists to the account · a followed brand is measurably more frequent in the next feed load.

E6 · Price drops & alerts

Feature	Detail	Type
Drop badges & shelf	"↓ X%" badges, struck old price, a row of current drops.	PROTO
Price tracking	Backend polls brand prices, records drops on saved and followed items.	NEW
Drop notifications	Push or email when a saved piece drops past a threshold.	NEW

ACCEPTANCE BARS Any piece with was > price shows the correct percent · drops shelf lists only currently-discounted pieces · a price change on a saved item fires exactly one notification per polling window.

E7 · Feed curator — the curation engine ★

The intelligence that assembles a cohesive cross-brand feed. This is the product's core and the subject of the agent prototype: configurable goal → plan → assemble → explain → adapt.

Feature	Detail	Type
Aesthetic brief input	Aesthetic, palette, budget, categories, occasion.	NEW
Cohesion assembly	Select pieces that fit the brief; balance palette and category so it reads as one look.	PROTO*
Rationale	Explain why pieces were chosen.	PROTO*
Constraints & learning	Respect budget and category coverage; feed saves and dismisses back into future curation.	NEW

* Demonstrated in the feed-curator agent prototype.

ACCEPTANCE BARS Given a brief, returns a set within budget covering the requested categories · stays within the palette family (≤ one accent) · every set ships with a short, specific rationale · changing budget or palette visibly changes the result.

CORE RISK ON THIS EPIC

E7 is the whole product, and most of it is still net-new. If the agent can't hit cohesion people accept (hypothesis H5), we don't ship a mediocre feed. The fallback is to hand-curate the launch catalogue and let the agent assist behind the scenes, moving more to it as it earns trust. Build E7 so a human curator can always override or seed it.

E8-E10 · Accounts, checkout hand-off, catalog

Epic	What it covers · key acceptance bar	Type
E8 Accounts & onboarding	Email/social login, aesthetic quiz, profile. New user reaches a curated feed in < 60s; choices persist through logout.	NEW
E9 Detail & outbound	"Shop at [brand]" affiliate deep-link, stock flags, click attribution. Buy link opens the right page with the affiliate tag; every click logged.	NEW
E10 Catalog ingestion	Normalise brand feeds; auto-tag aesthetic/colour/category (where Claude earns its keep); refresh price and stock. ≥ 90% of pieces auto-tagged.	NEW

THE DEPENDENCY TO RESPECT

E10 feeds everything. E1 and E7 have nothing to curate without a catalogue, and whether enough aesthetic-fit brands are reachable by affiliate is an open risk (hypothesis H6). So supply is the real gate: confirm a few reachable brands before building the ingestion pipeline, and start the launch catalogue hand-assembled rather than waiting on automation.

v1, prove the bet: the honest minimum is E1–E4 plus E7 in a lite, hand-assisted form, plus minimal accounts (E8) and outbound links (E9), over a curated catalogue of even a few hundred hand-checked pieces. That's enough to test cohesion and demand.

v1.1: brand shelf and follow-weighted feed (E5), price tracking and notifications (E6), semantic search, board sharing.

Later: the learning loop, automated ingestion at scale (E10), business-model experiments.

OPEN QUESTIONS

My recommendation on each is below; all stay open for you.

Two aesthetics at launch or a handful? Recommendation: two, as prototyped. Depth per aesthetic beats breadth while the catalogue is small.

Curate manually or by agent at launch? Recommendation: manual for launch with the agent assisting, then shift to agent as H5 proves out. Taste is the bet.

Which affiliate networks and brands are reachable for a real v1 catalogue? Recommendation: answer this first (it's hypothesis H6). It gates the whole build, so run the desk research before committing to ingestion.